25900074 MGU- UGP (HONOURS) REGULAR EXAMINATION, MARCH 2025
SECOND SEMESTER
MULTI DISCIPLINARY COURSES (MDC) – MG2MDCENG101
SPORTS LITERATURE AND CINEMA

Max marks: 50

Part A – MCQ
Answer all Questions. Each question carries 1 mark

1. C – The casual attitude towards scoring in Mumbai cricket. (CO1)
2. B – Boredom and monotony of their routine discussion. (CO2)
3. B – As a key value in cricket. (CO3)
4. B – Symbolises strength and perseverance. (CO3)
5. B – Aditi Singh. (CO3)

(1 x 5 = 5)

Part B – Short Answer
Answer any 6 Questions. Each question carries 5 marks

6. Sachin learnt a very important personal lesson – never to resort to unethical ways - play the sport with honesty and integrity – incident revolves around his first appearance in a newspaper – the rule in Mumbai back then was that a player's name only appeared in print if he had scored 30 runs – Sachin made 24 runs and the scorer decided to credit the extras in the team's innings and raised the score to 30 with Sachin's consent - Achrekar rebuked him for consenting to extras which were not his personal scores. (CO1)

7. Holiday Fun – offers a gripping and satirical exploration of human behavior – revolves around four friends who gather in Room No.70 of Nandavanam Lodge to escape their mundane lives – What starts as a lighthearted diversion of game of "police-and-thief" quickly becomes a catalyst for conflict, exposing the characters' egos, hypocrisies, and vulnerabilities. The characters' actions, driven by alcohol and suppressed frustrations, reveal the underlying power struggles along class and caste lines, exposing societal tensions (CO2)

8. In N.S. Madhavan's *Higuita*, risk-taking is central to the protagonist Father Georghese's moral transformation - priest is initially confined to traditional expectations - steps beyond these boundaries to protect Lucy from exploitation - This act embodies the spirit of René Higuita, the daring Colombian goalkeeper - His decision to confront Jabbar, the abuser, is a significant act of moral courage - challenges societal and religious norms - true faith requires action, not passivity - His risk-taking symbolizes personal growth - from a passive observer to an active protector - story critiques the passive morality of those around him - illustrates that inaction in the face of injustice is itself a moral failure - Madhavan uses risk-taking to explore themes of justice, integrity, and personal evolution - meaningful change often demands bold actions that challenge the status quo. (CO2)

9. Reinforces the Theme of Unity and Patriotism - speech emphasizes national pride and the importance of team unity, inspiring the players to see beyond personal differences and commit to a common goal - Addresses Personal and Collective Struggles - Kabir Khan speaks about overcoming past failures, discrimination, and personal sacrifices, motivating the players to channel their struggles into collective strength - Champions the Power of Believe and Determination: The speech underscores the importance of unwavering belief, resilience, and mental strength, crucial for high-stakes moments - Connects Cultural and Social Divides – reminds players of their diverse backgrounds - fosters a sense of inclusivity and shared identity, essential for a cohesive team - Prepares for High-Pressure Environments - acts as a psychological boost, calming nerves and sharpening focus, turning anxiety into motivation - Thematic Climax in the Narrative - speech serves as an emotional and narrative climax, transitioning from individual struggles to collective pride,

setting the stage for a victorious performance - Symbolic of Leadership and Vision - embodies the qualities of an inspiring leader - visionary, empathetic, and motivating - Memorable and Inspirational - As a cinematic moment, it encapsulates the core message of the film - believing in oneself and the team - leaving a lasting impact on viewers. (CO3)

10. Symbolism adds thematic depth to a film by using visual or narrative elements to represent and evoke complex ideas and emotions - enriches the narrative and provides a multi-layered experience through subtle, nuanced meanings beyond the literal - Examples from the syllabus include *Godha*, the hero's name, and the recurring Hanuman symbols, which stand for strength and perseverance and are significant in both life and sports. The film *83* examines the symbolic theme of post-colonial independence by drawing a comparison between the Indian cricket team's journey to England and this theme. *Invictus* uses rugby as a symbol of national aspiration - the same is with *Lagaan* - cricket. Symbolism is used to address gender, religion, minority identity and nationalism. (CO3)

Note: The question is vague and hence any sensible answer may be given marks.

11. *83* underscores that teamwork is essential for success by showcasing the Indian cricket team's collective effort during the 1983 World Cup - The film emphasizes unity, discipline, and trust among players despite individual differences and pressures - It highlights that victory isn't about individual brilliance alone but about coordinated strategies, mutual support, and shared sacrifices - The film portrays how strong teamwork builds resilience and confidence, enabling the team to overcome formidable opponents - Ultimately, *83* celebrates that success results from cohesive teamwork, collective belief, and relentless perseverance—values that transcend cricket and resonate universally. (CO3)

12. Mandela strategically employed rugby, a sport previously tied to apartheid, to help unite South Africa - deliberately supported the Springboks national team, persuading officials to keep their name and colours, symbols of the past, but now meant to include everyone - goal was to change the perception of rugby from a symbol of division to one of national pride and unity - invited the black population to share in the pride of the Springboks, fostering loyalty towards the nation and a shared national identity - prioritized the symbolic importance of the team and the sport for unity over potential political concerns. (CO3)

13. Films like *83, Chakde! India, Invictus* and *Lagaan* discuss the theme of the relationship between individual identity and national identity. 83 - Players' perseverance reflects overcoming discrimination and social barriers- Celebrating underdog stories - marginalized communities - representing India and win for the country-Chak *De India* addresses regionalism and unity - diverse backgrounds of the Indian women hockey players - highlights regional identities - emphasizes the importance of teamwork and national pride - Coach Kabir Khan's identity and past - national identity and collective efforts - India's strength in diversity -Mandela strategically employed rugby, a sport previously tied to apartheid, to help unite South Africa- Lagaan uses middle and lower class characters -eg. Kachra- cross section of Indian society - transcend their individual identities and hardships in order to achieve national triumph. (CO3)

Note: The question is vague and hence any sensible answer may be given marks.

14. *Lagaan* depicts villagers uniting against colonial oppression, using cricket as a symbol of resistance, emphasizing social justice and collective strength. The film highlights class divides, portraying how marginalized groups seek equality through sport - *83* celebrates India's cricket victory as a unifying national event, promoting themes of national pride, unity, and challenging social hierarchies - Both films use cricket as a metaphor for fighting oppression and fostering social cohesion. They explore how sports can inspire societal change, challenge injustice, and promote inclusivity in India's social fabric. (CO3)

Note: The question is vague and hence any sensible answer may be given marks.

(5 x 6 =30)

Part C - Essay
Answer any 1 question. Each question carries 15 marks

15. Rules are very important in play, giving expression to a cogent thought - Within the temporary play-world, players determine what "holds", and this defines its "absolute and peculiar order" - The principle underlying the rules of a game is an unshakable truth - Transgressing rules causes the whole play-world to collapse - Play is a recognized cultural function and a social construction - The strict order play demands may reflect the human instinct for law and order prominent in civilized life - Play communities form social groups, temporarily suspending normal social life but establishing their own structures. (CO1)

16. The Chess Players by Munshi Premchand is a historical fiction because it combines real historical events with fictional characters to depict the decline of Indian nobility during British colonial expansion. Set in Lucknow in 1856, the story takes place just before the British annexation of Awadh, a real historical event. The inclusion of Nawab Wajid Ali Shah, a historical figure known for his artistic interests and weak governance, adds authenticity to the setting. The fictional characters Mirza Sajjad Ali and Mir Roshan Ali, obsessed with playing chess, represent the moral decay and political apathy of the aristocracy. Their indifference to the political crisis reflects how such negligence contributed to the fall of native rule. Thus, the story uses a historical backdrop to offer a powerful social critique, making it a fine example of historical fiction.

(CO2)

17. *Chak De India* addresses regionalism and unity by showcasing the diverse backgrounds of the Indian women hockey players from different states and cultures, highlighting regional identities. The film depicts their initial mistrust and rivalries, rooted in regional differences, but emphasizes the importance of teamwork and national pride. Coach Kabir Khan’s leadership fosters unity by motivating players to look beyond regional loyalties and work together for a common goal. The narrative suggests that national identity and collective efforts can overcome regional divisions, portraying unity as essential for success and highlighting India’s strength in diversity.

(CO3)

(1 x 15 = 15)